

Q I'm still finding it tricky to get my baby latched on properly. Where can I get more support?

There are numerous avenues of support. In the early days, you may be able to access support from a breast-feeding consultant in your hospital or birth center. In hospital, nurses can check your technique and when you get home your pediatrician or a private lactation consultant can help.

If you need to talk to someone quickly, there are breast-feeding organizations that have help lines allowing you to talk to an experienced mother or breast-feeding consultant trained to offer advice and support. While talking on the phone can be very helpful, sometimes it isn't a

substitute for sitting with someone while they watch your feeding technique. Organizations such as La Leche League and local breast-feeding support groups provide drop-in meetings where you can meet other moms and often get one-on-one help from health-care professionals such as lactation consultants and nurses. When you were discharged from the hospital, you may have been given information about local chapters of La Leche League, support groups or even Meetup groups that gather regularly. If not, you can do an online search to find a group in your area. The camaraderie and support these group meetings provide can be invaluable.

Feeling supported by your partner is important, too. Having your partner's backing can give you encouragement to overcome

problems and continue breast-feeding. Don't delay seeking help if you encounter problems, since if you don't get on top of an issue, it can quickly escalate. Most problems can be resolved with the right advice and support.

Around 75%
of new moms seek help
with breast-feeding.
Most work through their
problems and go on to
breast-feed successfully.

Q Breast-feeding is so convenient, but I feel anxious about doing it in public. How can I get confidence?

Knowing your rights and thinking ahead can help counter initial jitters about public breast-feeding. It is normal to feel self-conscious in the beginning, but in time you will grow in confidence and it will become second nature.

One of the joys of breast-feeding is that you can feed your baby any time or place as soon as she is hungry. Your breast milk is always available at the right temperature in the exact amount your baby needs, so when you start to venture out with your baby, you don't have to do preparation such as sanitizing bottles and measuring the formula you need.

Breast-feeding is simply extremely convenient. Most mothers find that it's easy to choose a spot where they can feed their baby discreetly, and that actually the majority of people barely notice, or if they do, they are entirely respectful.

Your right to breast-feed in public

Occasionally, you may get a disapproving look or comment, which makes you feel self-conscious and perhaps even a little humiliated, even though breast-feeding is the most natural thing in the world. So it's good to know that you do have rights in such a situation. In the US, 49 states (all except Idaho) and the District of Columbia have laws which allow women to breast-feed their babies at any private or public location within the state. And 29 states specifically address breast-feeding and public indecency, stating

that breast-feeding is exempt from such a charge. You have rights in the workplace, too. The Affordable Care Act of 2010 requires employers to provide reasonable break time for nursing moms to express breast milk for the first year of a baby's life, in a location other than a bathroom. And 27 states have added their own laws about breast-feeding in the workplace.

Planning ahead

Think about what you are wearing: loose tops you can lift up a little to let your baby latch on help to make breast-feeding discreet. Aside from an initial flash of flesh, it's pretty hard to see anything other than your baby. Wearing a loose tank under a T-shirt means you can pull this down to hide your postpartum belly, and often, your arm cradling your baby will do this job. Practice opening your nursing bra with one hand, too.

Some women use a burp cloth or a breast-feeding scarf for a little extra cover, but others feel that this actually draws attention to you. Go with whatever feels best—if covering up feels more reassuring, that's fine, but you shouldn't ever feel you have to hide yourself when breast-feeding your baby.



Confident feeding Breast-feeding your baby is natural and not something you should have to hide or be embarrassed about.